



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Legislation and regulation: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-21

Edition of 2026-08-21 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

56 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

## Algeria

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                           | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Domestic online-platform regulation (local presence, takedown, data residency) | Did not exist     | Under examination; bill text not held and adoption not established                                                                               | ADVANCED          |
| National information-verification ("fact-checking") system                     | Did not exist     | Draft examined; no regulator, legal basis or oversight mechanism named                                                                           | ADVANCED          |
| Presidential Decree 25-320 — national public-data governance framework         | Did not exist     | 20 articles in force; art. 19 classification and cataloguing not shown to have commenced                                                         | ADVANCED          |
| Law 18-05 on electronic commerce                                               | BASELINE NOT HELD | In force; the great majority of online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, with cash on delivery dominant (2026-08) | Baseline not held |

## Angola

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Artificial intelligence bill | Did not exist | An 86-article draft in nine chapters out for public consultation, with a single critical-AI category carrying registration, security-risk assessment and emergency-response duties rather than a tiered risk pyramid, extraterritorial reach over activity abroad affecting Angolan interests, a right to explanation and to refuse AI-based decisions, criminal and strict civil liability, and no repeal of existing legislation; no tabling, committee stage or vote on record | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                              | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Cybersecurity bill</b>                            | No cybersecurity law in force, and nothing held on a bill                                                  | Adopted by the National Assembly on 2026-08-12 by 104 votes to 56, on a presidential initiative, with the MPLA for and UNITA against and no abstentions; graduated administrative fines set as multiples of the national minimum wage, from 7 to 70 for individuals on minor infractions up to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious ones; no promulgation, gazette number or entry into force on file. It requires telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, which UNITA and part of civil society object to as leaving unclear which content qualifies and on what terms subscribers' personal data reaches the authorities, a year before the presidential election | ADVANCED |
| <b>Digital government bill</b>                       | No framework law; sector rules dispersed since 1997                                                        | In public consultation, framed expressly around ending legislative dispersion and keeping the digital law and the data-protection law in step                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ADVANCED |
| <b>Electronic signature and certification regime</b> | A public-key and time-stamp infrastructure announced by the ministry with no legislation, date or location | Authorisation granted to the President, valid 90 days after publication of the enabling law; the substantive text will be an executive instrument defining an accrediting authority, a root certification entity and the evidential weight of a signature                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED |
| <b>National cybersecurity centre</b>                 | Did not exist                                                                                              | A public institute with legal personality and administrative and financial autonomy, carrying regulatory, supervisory, inspection and sanctioning powers, an internal emergency response team and a round-the-clock operations department, retaining 30% of the fines it levies. On 2026-08-10 the telecommunications minister said the centre would be launched during 2026, to monitor digital threats, defend critical infrastructure and coordinate incident response                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED |
| <b>Online falsehoods law</b>                         | Did not exist                                                                                              | In force since 4 August 2026, gazetted as Lei n. 6/26 in Diário da República I Serie n. 146 after the Assembleia Nacional passed it 105-72 in May with only UNITA opposed; fines of 200-400 minimum wages, one to three years for simple publication, three to eight where it incites hatred or damages reputation, and up to ten in the aggravated case                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED |
| <b>Startups law</b>                                  | Did not exist                                                                                              | Passed, with a legal definition of a startup at an annual revenue ceiling of about US\$3.5m and no minimum threshold, admitting pre-revenue ventures                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED |

## Benin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                          | AT 2025-08-01         | AT 2026-08-21                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Extension of the biometric register to foreigners and Afro-descendants</b> | Did not exist         | Residents file with distinct foreigner and Afro-descendant identifiers | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Tax measures pushing merchants onto digital rails</b>                      | In force (2025-01)    | Levy plus the 2026 rectifying finance law's digital taxes              | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Décret 2020-209 instituting the exchange</b>                               | In force (2020-03-18) | In force; the signed decree now on file                                | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Identity-linked SIM registration</b>                                       | In force (2025-04)    | In force                                                               | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                        | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data-localisation law</b> | Did not exist | Committed only; no draft, scope or timetable on file | ADVANCED |

## Botswana

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                               | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cybersecurity Act 2025</b>                                   | Not enacted; a Bill only (2025-08)                                                          | Made and gazetted, not in force at 2026-08-06, the stated April 2026 commencement having passed                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED, THE STATED APRIL 2026 COMMENCEMENT NOT ON RECORD |
| <b>Digital Services Act</b>                                     | Passed 2024, not in force; a standalone services agency publicly contested (2025-08-18)     | In force; the compliance clock runs to November 2027                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED                                                   |
| <b>Electronic Payment Services (Amendment) Regulations 2026</b> | Did not exist                                                                               | In operation; scope extended to money or value transfer services, fit-and-proper reaching beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years                                                                   | ADVANCED                                                   |
| <b>National Cybersecurity Authority</b>                         | Did not exist (2025-08)                                                                     | Created in law with a board, chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate; not established, and no organisation or vote in the FY2026/27 estimates | ADVANCED                                                   |
| <b>Remote Service VAT Act</b>                                   | Announced, not in effect; the tax system described as built for tangible goods (2026-03-23) | In effect, with a stated collection target of about P450m a year                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                                                   |
| <b>Virtual Asset Act 2022 and provider licensing</b>            | Act in force, crypto not legal tender (2025-07)                                             | Act in force; the regional assessor still records provider-oversight shortcomings (2026-02)                                                                                                                                                                      | NO CHANGE                                                  |

## Burkina Faso

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                                            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Fast-track procurement decree</b>    | A fast-track procurement route with loose conditions of recourse                         | Recourse restricted to national sovereignty, strategic character, grave threat to public order, security or service continuity, and humanitarian consequences of insecurity | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Headquarters-localisation decree</b> | Did not exist                                                                            | Firms above a revenue threshold must build headquarters in-country, with building standards set by revenue band                                                             | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Information-systems security law</b> | In force since July 2024, with the auditor-accreditation duty asserted without machinery | Now carrying a decree identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, plus a decree fixing periodic audits and auditor accreditation   | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Whistleblower protection law</b>     | Carried by the justice minister, in preparation                                          | No held source records adoption or any further step in the eighteen months since                                                                                            | NO CHANGE |

## Burundi

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT              | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Access to information bill</b> | Did not exist | Scheduled for examination; no text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable published | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21           | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| Anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing regime | Baseline not held | Five circulars in force | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Cameroon

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                                        | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT         |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Loi n. 2010/012 on cybercrime and cybersecurity | In force and invoked to justify network restrictions | In force and invoked to justify network restrictions; civil-society reform recommendations are pending and none is adopted on record | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

## Cape Verde

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Diploma on interoperability standards for public-administration systems | Announced for drafting in 2024 under the state-modernisation strategy; no adoption on record                                 | Unchanged; no evidence the diploma was adopted, two years past its stated year, while interoperability is asserted as a working property of the government portal and the company registry                                                                                                         | <b>STALLED</b>   |
| Diploma regulating data governance in the public administration         | Announced for drafting in 2024; no adoption on record                                                                        | Unchanged; no evidence of adoption at 2026-08-06. A companion diploma on documentary classification, announced in the same statement, is likewise unadopted                                                                                                                                        | <b>STALLED</b>   |
| Legal frameworks for digital services, e-commerce and digital banking   | Did not exist                                                                                                                | Named among the declared reach of the National 5G Strategy approved on 2026-02-20, alongside a regulatory and business framework to support investment; no bill, draft or diploma is held                                                                                                          | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| Satellite communications regulatory framework (ARME)                    | Did not exist                                                                                                                | Consultation covers licensing, radio-spectrum use, frequency coordination, user protection, network security and emergency communications for satellite operators; a direct regulatory response to Starlink's December 2024 launch in the archipelago; no draft text or adoption date is published | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| General authorisation regime for electronic communications              | Five operators authorised after ARME granted two new general authorisations in 2024; Starlink began activity in January 2025 | Unchanged; no further authorisation or licensing change is recorded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

## Central African Republic

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT         |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Public procurement code          | The 2008 law governing, seventeen years in force and criticised in the explanatory memorandum for transparency, competition and control gaps | A new code with a FCFA 10,000,000 publicity threshold, a 5% preference margin for national and regional firms, a FCFA 2,500,000,000 small-business participation threshold and an eight-working-day formal notice | <b>ADVANCED</b>  |
| Cybersecurity and cybercrime law | In force from early 2024, carrying six to ten year sentences and fines of FCFA 5m to 10m                                                     | Unchanged in text; named by a commentator in July 2026 as the instrument now used against online content                                                                                                          | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

## Chad

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                         | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>Code du numerique</b>                                                                       | No record at the window's opening; the code's development is dated from December 2025 | No adopted text, number, promulgation date or gazette reference                                                                | STALLED                            |
| <b>Committee to overhaul the digital, electronic communications and postal legal framework</b> | Did not exist                                                                         | Inaugurated with a forty-five-day deadline, and no draft, report or text on record                                             | ADVANCED, THEN NO OUTPUT ON RECORD |
| <b>Loi n 013/PR/2014 on electronic communications and postal regulation, as amended</b>        | In force unamended                                                                    | In force with article 18 amended; the amending ordinance's text is not held, so the article's current wording cannot be stated | ADVANCED                           |

## Comoros

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | AT 2026-08-20                                                                      | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Code numerique</b>                                                 | Not adopted, the 2024 target already missed                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Not adopted                                                                        | STALLED   |
| <b>Cybercrime provisions of the penal code</b>                        | In force, covering technology-specific offences, online intellectual-property infringement, illicit conduct on electronic communications networks and online service-provider liability                                                                                | Unchanged; no prosecution, caseload or enforcement figure is on file at either end | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Cybersecurity law</b>                                              | Drafted and not enacted                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Unchanged; the base carries no position dated after 2021-03-04                     | NO CHANGE |
| <b>E-commerce law</b>                                                 | Not drafted                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Unchanged                                                                          | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Electronic-signature instrument</b>                                | Did not exist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Did not exist                                                                      | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Loi n 14-031/AU on electronic communications, as amended</b>       | In force as amended; the regulator is funded by a statutory levy of 2 per cent of prior-year pre-tax turnover for licence holders, 1 per cent for authorisations and 0.5 per cent for declarations, plus a tenth of licence fees and two-fifths of pecuniary sanctions | Unchanged                                                                          | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Revised public procurement code for dematerialised procurement</b> | Drafted and not enacted                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Unchanged, with no procurement platform on record                                  | NO CHANGE |

## Congo

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                         | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Certified electronic invoicing decree</b>       | A voluntary pilot group, with electronic invoicing described by external staff as a component of the tax platform whose implementation was incomplete | Mandatory for every economic agent except the state, local authorities on public-service missions and diplomatic bodies, with terminals, software and enterprise modules homologated jointly by the tax directorate and the security agency         | ADVANCED |
| <b>Electronic-invoicing implementing orders</b>    | Did not exist                                                                                                                                         | A four-stage homologation with a 30-day decision deadline, mandatory cryptographic certification, a penetration test under twelve months old, a sworn no-backdoor attestation, ten-year invoice retention and real-time tax-directorate data access | ADVANCED |
| <b>Public-revenue payment order</b>                | Did not exist                                                                                                                                         | All public revenue payable exclusively through one national platform, defined in the text as a national and sovereign payments switch; payment outside it is void and non-discharging, and administrations must suppress every parallel circuit     | ADVANCED |
| <b>Tax on newly imported SIM-capable terminals</b> | Did not exist                                                                                                                                         | Levied on importers of newly imported phones and tablets, paid by bank transfer with mobile-money channels announced, and earmarked for connectivity, digital services and infrastructure                                                           | ADVANCED |

## Cote d'Ivoire

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                               | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>National cyber-security agency</b>                                          | Agency launched and consolidating the cybercrime unit, the national computer emergency team and the alert line                              | Operating agency running a national security operations centre, a public-administration security-officer network, the national public key infrastructure and auditor certification against the state security reference framework | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Regulatory Council of the telecoms authority</b>                            | Outgoing council, whose mandate took more than a thousand sector decisions                                                                  | New six-year council installed, with a roadmap of priorities handed to the minister                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Loi n 2013-546 on electronic transactions</b>                               | In force with article 50 repealed                                                                                                           | In force; its 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees on cryptology, electronic signature and digital archiving are the stated legal basis of the national public key infrastructure                                                   | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Ordonnance n 2024-950 transferring the cyber mandate</b>                    | Ratified, moving network security, audit, certification and electronic-certificate issuance from the telecoms regulator to the cyber agency | Unchanged in law; the transferred certificate mandate is now exercised through the national public key infrastructure                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Loi n 2024-352 on electronic communications</b>                             | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                    | In force, with 2025 operator compliance action plans evaluated, licence terms under revision and a common conformity framework being defined                                                                                      | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| <b>Procedure for handling consumer complaints on electronic communications</b> | Not held                                                                                                                                    | In draft and out to stakeholder consultation on 13 and 14 August 2026 with operators, internet service providers and consumer associations, implementing Law No. 2024-352 on electronic communications                            | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Djibouti

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01        | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                 | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Startup Act (Loi n 179/AN/25)</b>                    | Did not exist        | In force from promulgation; every operative detail deferred to implementing decrees (2025-12) | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Digital Code (eight volumes, about 800 articles)</b> | Adopted 30 June 2025 | In force; no implementing decree held                                                         | NO CHANGE |

## DR Congo

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Bill on the identification of natural persons</b>                   | Did not exist                                                                                                     | Tabled; it would set one legal frame for identification data and its collection, processing, retention and protection, impose security and interoperability requirements and connect civil-registry, migration and health databases; no committee report or plenary date is held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Interministerial order on digital-sector duties, taxes and fees</b> | Did not exist                                                                                                     | A two-tier dollar schedule keyed to whether a provider is judged dominant: cloud services US\$5,000 local and US\$15,000 foreign in the first tier against US\$2,500 and US\$10,000 in the second; data-centre declaration from US\$25,000 to US\$100,000 by tier; one startup line at US\$100. In force on signature 2026-07-20 under its article 5; a surseance announced by the finance ministry on 1 August 2026 and denied on 6 August 2026, neither position resting on a published government text; ministry's 8 August statement confirms registered 'entreprenant' start-ups are now fully exempt (not merely the US\$100 line reported earlier), still with no gazetted order or amending text published | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Code du numérique</b>                                               | The framework law in force, its third book governing personal data, with no data-protection authority operational | The same law in force, a legal scholar dating the shift from an embryonic 2020 telecom law to extensive data-protection coverage                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Satellite internet service-provider licence</b>                     | Licensed since May 2025                                                                                           | Still licensed; the licence conditions, spectrum awards and any enforcement outcome are not established                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Social register decree</b>                                          | A draft decree adopted in council                                                                                 | No promulgated decree number, signature date or publication held at 2026-08-06                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Joint subcontracting enforcement by two regulators</b>              | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                          | A harmonised reading of the legal texts, joint inspection teams and enforcement of local-content subcontracting rules on large operators, with scope stated beyond telecoms to digital services and electronic commerce                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Egypt

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                           |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>Child national ID card proposal</b> | Not on record | A member's proposal for a national identity card for children carrying a photograph from age five, requiring amendment of the Child Law, discussed at two workshops; recommendations included a unified national child-data platform, a full biometric identification system for children, and linkage between health, education and other government databases. No bill has been tabled | ADVANCED, A MEMBER'S PROPOSAL ONLY |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Electronic service of judicial notices</b>                        | Not on record                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | The postal service's digital postbox becomes the official platform for electronic delivery of judicial notices to individuals, companies and institutions, bound to the user's national identification number and carrying identity verification, electronic signatures and seals, encryption, delivery timestamps and correspondence tracking, so that a registered electronic message has the same legal validity as registered paper mail | ADVANCED                         |
| <b>PDPL Executive Regulations, Decree 816 of 2025</b>                | Did not exist. The Alexandria Economic Court decided the Orange Egypt case in February 2025 on tort grounds precisely because the regulations were still pending, more than four years after the law passed                                                                                                                                      | In force, establishing the approvals model, a separate licence for each cross-border transfer specifying destination, purpose, data categories and safeguards, extra approvals for electronic marketing and certain public-space surveillance, registered data-protection officers, and breach notification within 72 hours to the regulator and three business days to affected individuals                                                 | ADVANCED                         |
| <b>Real property register conversion, Manshah section, Sohag</b>     | The title register was due to take effect for the Manshah city survey section on 2026-07-01 under a decision of 2000                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Deferred by one year to 2027-07-01 by a justice ministry decision published in the Official Gazette, with settlement forms admitted for that section for two months from 2026-07-01 to complete the legal procedures                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | STALLED                          |
| <b>Regulator unit monitoring AI-manipulated social-media content</b> | Not on record                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | The ICT minister told Cabinet that a unit had been formed inside the telecommunications regulator which already detects and acts on AI-manipulated video and imagery, but that legislative amendment is needed to address the practices at root                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                         |
| <b>Social-media legislative review</b>                               | Not on record; the base holds no proposal to amend the social-media statutes before 2026-07-29                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | A cabinet meeting chaired by the Prime Minister agreed on a review of the governing statutes, heavier financial penalties and public awareness campaigns; the ICT minister said a comparative study of other states' approaches is being prepared. No bill, text or timetable is stated                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED                         |
| <b>Standalone digital-privacy statute proposal</b>                   | No standalone digital-privacy bill on record                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | A member called on the government to bring forward a comprehensive digital-privacy bill criminalising recording and publication without consent, imposing takedown duties on platforms, raising penalties where fake accounts, defamation, extortion or vulnerable victims are involved, and widening investigators' powers to trace anonymous accounts                                                                                      | ADVANCED, A MEMBER'S DEMAND ONLY |
| <b>Property ID Law</b>                                               | Approved by the House, having been introduced in August 2023; it mandates a unique digital ID for every property recording location, use, ownership, licensing, violations and transaction history, tied to a unified digital base map, and makes the property ID a prerequisite for registry or notary registration and for utility connections | Unchanged; no prime-ministerial decree naming the overseeing authority, no executive regulations and no commencement date are on record fifteen months later                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE                        |



| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Regulatory framework for foreign satellite operators</b> | In force since 2024-07-09, the standing licensing instrument for any foreign satellite operator serving earth-station terminals in Egypt, granting categorical licences to operators supplying space capacity to licensed providers | Unchanged; no foreign low-earth-orbit operator has been licensed under it                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Digital space bill</b>                                   | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                            | A 54-article, seven-chapter party draft that would require digital platforms to appoint a legal representative in the country and register influencers on a national platform, and would regulate the use of artificial intelligence, deepfakes, online extortion, gambling and child protection online; not tabled, and no text is published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| <b>Financial Regulatory Authority technology sandbox</b>    | The base carries no position on the sandbox at 2025-08-01; the authority states that 2026-08 closes its first year                                                                                                                  | Live testing approved for three months, renewable, for two of the seven projects given preliminary approval in the first year: remote inspection and damage assessment in comprehensive motor insurance, and verification of foreign nationals' identities by reading electronic passports with NFC-equipped phones against international travel-document public-key standards, so that non-Egyptians can reach insurance, investment and other non-banking financial services; the authority reports 49 applications received, 7 given preliminary approval, 2 in live testing and regulatory guidance given to 45 entities | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Equatorial Guinea

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                         | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Reform of the Ley de Prensa y Medios Audiovisuales (1997)</b> | In force since 1997, with no provision for digital media or cable TV                                                  | Bill presented adding regulation of digital media and cable television for the first time, under committee review, with no adoption date or bill text published; a separate Copyright and Related Rights bill was presented alongside it, implementing Equatorial Guinea's 1997 Berne Convention accession and its 2015 Bangui Agreement obligations under OAPI | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Ley 7/2024 on social media and computer crime</b>             | In force                                                                                                              | In force, with its provisions reported in rollout from July 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Reform of Ley 7/2005 General de Telecomunicaciones</b>        | Tender opened, scoped to cover AI, cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, satellite connectivity and data protection | No award, draft or revised timetable has been published in the fourteen months since                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE |

## Eritrea

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Bank of Eritrea cash-deposit legal notice</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In force; no definition given of an 'excessive amount' held outside banks, and no enforcement mechanism specified; deposit deadline 31 Jul 2026 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Eswatini

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                  | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, e-commerce and AI legislation | Did not exist | Announced as forthcoming; no bill text or tabling date on file                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED |
| Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026                               | Did not exist | Complete on the ministry's account, introducing publisher registration and rules on accuracy, privacy, child safeguarding and the responsible use of AI; text and commencement date not public | ADVANCED |

## Ethiopia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-21                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Telecommunications Licensing Directive 792/2021 | In force (2021-07) | In force; unified operator licences awarded by competitive bidding and valid fifteen years | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Berne Convention accession                                       | Did not exist | Draft ratification proclamation submitted to the Council of Ministers; Ethiopia not yet a party                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                                                 |
| Copyright Proclamation 410/2004 online-infringement amendment    | Did not exist | Draft would add internet service provider duties, procedures for blocking infringing sites and a rights-holder take-down notice to the 2004 proclamation                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                                                 |
| Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation No. 1426/2026 | Did not exist | 12 critical sectors designated, 18 core obligations on owners and operators, and a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund; art.28 sets a one-year transition to commencement after gazettelement (about July 2027); the Council of Ministers and INSA hold regulation-making powers under arts.26-27 | ADVANCED                                                 |
| Judicial review of licence revocation without court order        | Did not exist | December 2025 decree struck down; revocation without a court order held unconstitutional                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                                                 |
| Prohibition of virtual assets                                    | Did not exist | The whole category prohibited absent express authorisation; no new rule, no enforcement mechanism                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                                                 |
| Tax assessment of payment gateways                               | Did not exist | Three-year throughput restated from ETB 32bn to 143.9bn and taxed; corrected data refused                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED, AS AN ENFORCEMENT ACTION RATHER THAN AS POLICY |

## Gabon

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                          | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Five implementing texts on the digitalisation of teaching             | Did not exist                                          | Five drafts validated - two decrees on digitalised learning and on blended-learning platforms, two orders on assessment and on the steering committee, and a decree creating the basic computing certificate | ADVANCED |
| Ordonnance n 0006/PR/2025 on digitalisation and electronic government | No comprehensive legal basis for electronic government | In force, mandating digitisation of administrative services, compulsory interconnection between administrations, and a national-preference clause in digital public procurement                              | ADVANCED |
| Ordonnance of 8 April 2026 on the regulation of digital platforms     | Did not exist                                          | In force, with provisions judged disproportionate by the association that recommends its revision                                                                                                            | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | AT 2025-08-01           | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Loi n 027/2023 on cybersecurity and cybercrime</b>           | In force, text not held | In force, text not held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Draft Code of Civil Procedure</b>                            | Not held                | A justice ministry commission submitted a draft running to more than 800 pages, rewriting the 1977 ordinance to introduce digitised and dematerialised procedural filings and secure digital tools, and to harmonise with the OHADA uniform acts; professional consultation and parliamentary debate are still ahead | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| <b>Legal framework for the national digital identity system</b> | No position held        | Two texts named - a law on the personal identification number and a law on the national civil registry centre - with no adoption, promulgation or gazette date for either                                                                                                                                            | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| <b>Social-media regulation bill</b>                             | No position held        | Reported to exist and to await promulgation, with no title, number or adoption date given                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Gambia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                        | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Communications Bill 2025</b>        | Not introduced; first reading followed on 19 November 2025 (2025-08) | Passed second reading and referred to committee, with the Press Union pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (2026-07)                                               | ADVANCED          |
| <b>State Intelligence Service Bill</b> | Did not exist                                                        | Draft validated, reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures and to give the Assembly review of the Service's budgets and operations; not tabled (2026-07) | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Access to Information Act</b>       | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                    | In force, but with most public institutions yet to appoint the information officers the Act requires and twenty-one-day requests going unanswered                                         | Baseline not held |

## Ghana

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data Exchange Act</b>                          | None published                                                                               | Named by the ministry as a statute distinct from harmonisation, carrying interoperability and inter-agency sharing, with no draft or timetable                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED |
| <b>Data Harmonisation Bill</b>                    | Named as a forthcoming Act the new board must support, with no draft                         | Consulted on and still a bill, renamed an Act in the July 2026 AI plan, not laid before Parliament                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED |
| <b>Electronic Transactions Bill 2025</b>          | The 2008 electronic transactions Act as the standing baseline, with no replacement on record | A draft that would mandate age verification for child-accessible services, ban targeted advertising to children and impose risk assessments and semi-annual transparency reports on very large platforms                                                                | ADVANCED |
| <b>Right to Information Act 2019 (Act 989)</b>    | Baseline not held                                                                            | In force and enforced: the Right to Information Commission fined 254 public bodies GHS 20,000 each for failing to file their mandatory 2025 annual reports, after reminders published in the Gazette; no collection figure, appeal outcome or compliance rate published | ADVANCED |
| <b>SIM re-registration legislative instrument</b> | Baseline not held                                                                            | Still not laid on file, with the first-quarter 2026 start date passed and a later-in-2026 rollout restated in February                                                                                                                                                  | STALLED  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                              | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025</b>             | No statute, with more than 3 million virtual-asset users and over 100 service providers recorded in a July 2025 registration exercise, and regulated institutions directed not to facilitate virtual-asset activity at all | In force on the regulator's account, risk-based and technology-neutral with capital adequacy, client-asset custody and anti-money-laundering duties, supervision split between the central bank and the securities regulator by activity, licensing attaching to the service rather than to holding, virtual assets excluded from deposit protection and from any statutory compensation fund and barred from invoicing, pricing and wages, transition arrangements for existing operators, and the licensing requirements still being built | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Electronic Communications Act 2008</b>                   | In force as the licensing statute for electronic communications                                                                                                                                                            | Unchanged; the statute under which 5G licences and submarine-cable landings are granted, which establishes the universal-access fund and sources it from contributions stipulated in each licence rather than from any rate set in the Act                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Innovation and Startup Bill</b>                          | A draft startup law under development, with no text                                                                                                                                                                        | Still forthcoming, now tied to a national financial-technology fund it would give a legal base and eligibility criteria, with no draft published and none laid                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Digital banking framework</b>                            | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Framework and comprehensive draft guidelines complete, awaiting stakeholder consultation before implementation, with no date                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Baseline not held |
| <b>Digital Economy and Innovation Development Fund Bill</b> | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Under legislative review, converting the universal-access fund into a wider digital-infrastructure, innovation and skills fund; levy rate, governance structure and the fate of the rural-access earmark all unestablished                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Baseline not held |
| <b>Emerging Technologies Bill</b>                           | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                                                                          | A draft that would create an emerging-technologies agency for cross-functional compliance across artificial intelligence, blockchain, connected devices, cloud and quantum, with voluntary startup registration                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Baseline not held |
| <b>Identity agency Act amendment</b>                        | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Would place the identity agency permanently under the interior ministry and grant security agencies defined access to the biometric citizen database                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Baseline not held |
| <b>Information technology agency bill</b>                   | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                                                                                                                                          | A draft that would overhaul the 2008 law, license every technology business, certify professionals, regulate artificial intelligence and blockchain and levy 1% on services, and split the agency's regulatory and commercial arms                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Baseline not held |

## Guinea

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Digital Analysis and Regulation Platform (PARN)</b>              | Did not exist      | Created by decree; not on record as operating                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Digital Compliance Fee (RCN) on foreign digital services</b>     | Did not exist      | 3% flat rate for twelve months, then 1.5-7% by service category; exemption below 250m GNF of annual taxable revenue                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Digital Sovereignty Fund (FSN)</b>                               | Did not exist      | Created by decree; no capitalisation, governance or first disbursement published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED  |
| <b>ARPT supervision of electronic transactions and mobile money</b> | In force (2025-08) | In force: the posts and telecommunications regulator regulates and supervises electronic transactions including mobile money, with network and information-system security oversight, data collection, administrative police powers and the power to levy charges on mobile-money and electronic-payment traffic (2026-08) | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Conseil National de Paiement</b>                                 | Does not exist     | Does not exist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01       | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Loi L/2016/035/AN on electronic transactions</b> | In force (2025-08)  | In force as the frame for electronic signature, digital archiving, certification of information systems, consumer information duties in online commerce and the related fraud and forgery offences (2026-08) | NO CHANGE |
| <b>Payment systems law</b>                          | No payments statute | No payments statute                                                                                                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE |

## Guinea-Bissau

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                         | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Digital Integrity (Dissemination of False Information on the Internet) Law</b> | Did not exist                                                                         | Enacted 21 May 2026 (CNT unanimous passage, with amendments); publication/in-force date and enforcement mechanisms unconfirmed; first invoked by the Ministry of Communication on 21 Jul 2026 over a false TikTok-shutdown claim | ADVANCED |
| <b>Electronic Communications Law (revised)</b>                                    | Did not exist - the 2010 Electronic Communications regime remained nominally in force | Council of Ministers approved a revised bill, with amendments; not yet confirmed passed by the CNT or in force                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED |

## Kenya

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                   | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Access to Information (Amendment) Bill</b>   | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Would criminalise sharing classified information through personal messaging or email, on four classification tiers                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED  |
| <b>AI Governance Act</b>                        | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Named in the draft policy as the statutory backstop, with no text, sponsor or date                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Computer Misuse and Cybercrimes Act 2018</b> | In force with false-publication offences and a non-judicial website-shutdown power                              | Narrowed by litigation, with the false-publication sections and the shutdown power struck and a conservatory order blocking a national internet shutdown                                                                                                                                | REGRESSED |
| <b>Copyright and Related Rights Bill 2026</b>   | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Out for comment, creating a Copyright Authority and a disputes tribunal, and carrying the 2001 computer-generated-work authorship rule forward unchanged                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Kenya National Library Service Bill 2023</b> | Published 2023-06-14 to repeal the Kenya National Library Service Act 1965, with no digital provision on record | At Senate committee hearing, with the ICT ministry asking that electronic legal deposit, a national digital knowledge repository, digital preservation of public records, AI-supported cataloguing and interoperability with government digital infrastructure be written into the Bill | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Sexual Offences Act amendment package</b>    | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Pre-parliamentary proposals on sextortion, stalking, voyeurism and AI-generated or altered intimate imagery, with an institutional duty to report                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Technopolis Act</b>                          | Did not exist                                                                                                   | In force, giving innovation cities including Konza a standalone legal framework with a development authority and a disputes tribunal                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Technopolis Regulations</b>                  | Did not exist                                                                                                   | Not finalised, with no draft on file                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025</b> | Did not exist                                                                                                   | In force, with pre-existing operators given until 2026-11-04 to comply                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Virtual Asset Service Providers Regulations 2026              | Did not exist     | Gazetted as Legal Notice 134, with joint central bank and capital markets licensing across ten categories, capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for advisers, and a seizure and freezing framework; Binance, Luno, VALR, Yellow Card, Kotani Pay and Roqqu have said they intend to apply, and the regulators had not announced the application process as at 2026-08-07                                                            | ADVANCED          |
| Cyber cafe customer registration and session logging rules    | BASELINE NOT HELD | Operators must capture each customer's name and identity number, the terminal used and session times, and retain the records at least three years, on pain of fines of up to 0.2% of annual turnover with a minimum of about US\$3,860. The regulator clarified on 2026-08-13 that the conditions do not require operators to track customers' browsing history. The licence conditions were published by gazette notice on 2026-08-07 and take effect on 2026-09-07 | Baseline not held |
| ICT Authority Bill                                            | BASELINE NOT HELD | On the forward legislative list with no text, sponsor or stage on file                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Baseline not held |
| Kenya Information and Communications (Amendment) Bill 2025    | Baseline not held | Before Parliament, proposing mandatory consumption-based internet billing; an internet service provider told the House the requirement could raise costs and create data-privacy risks, since metering consumption at subscriber level implies retaining usage records. No committee report, amendment schedule or enactment date is published                                                                                                                       | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| Kenya Intellectual Property Bill                              | BASELINE NOT HELD | Would merge three agencies into a new authority with an intellectual-property tribunal; the draft would merge the industrial property institute, the copyright board and the anti-counterfeit authority into one regulator, replace the 2001 and 2008 statutes, and set rules distinguishing AI-assisted from AI-generated inventions, with Parliament inviting public submissions                                                                                   | Baseline not held |
| Persons with Disabilities Act 2025                            | BASELINE NOT HELD | In force but setting no AI accessibility standards and no enforcement mechanism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Baseline not held |
| Repeal of the IEBC duty to livestream polling-station results | BASELINE NOT HELD | Two bills would remove the commission's statutory duty to create a mechanism for livestreaming results from the polling station: the Elections (Amendment) Bill 2024, passed by the Senate in December 2024 and awaiting the National Assembly, and the Election Laws (Amendment) Bill 2026, sponsored jointly by the Senate majority and minority leaders. Neither is enacted                                                                                       | Baseline not held |

## Lesotho

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Cybercrime Bill      | BASELINE NOT HELD | Split out of the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill and awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable                                                      | Baseline not held |
| Cybersecurity Bill   | BASELINE NOT HELD | Split out of the Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill, intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, and awaiting National Assembly approval | Baseline not held |

## Liberia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                          | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>LTA licensing and spectrum reform package</b>             | Licensing under the Telecommunications Act 2007 unchanged, with no satellite or device rules (2025-08) | Split of infrastructure and service licences, tower-sharing rules, first satellite regulations, an IMEI regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain announced; none published as instruments (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>Mobile Money Regulations (Central Bank of Liberia)</b>    | In force (2025-08)                                                                                     | In force and unamended; the interoperable fee schedule of 2026 was approved under it (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Satellite Communications Guidelines (LTA-GL-002-2026)</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                               | A licensing regime in force: five-year non-geostationary and ten-year geostationary landing rights, a US\$250,000 direct-to-device service-provider licence fee with 9% of direct-to-device sales and a 0.5% universal-access contribution, mandatory data-protection and cybersecurity compliance plans, and a twelve-month transition for existing operators | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Libya

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Comprehensive cybersecurity law</b>                | None published                                     | In drafting on the eastern legislative track                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>E-payment mandate for state revenue collection</b> | Did not exist                                      | Treasuries and collecting agencies must accept electronic payment                   | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Law No. 22 of 2010 on telecommunications</b>       | In force; sole licensing power asserted by the GTI | In force; licensing jurisdiction contested between the GTI and the eastern ministry | NO CHANGE |

## Madagascar

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                    | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Cybercrime bill overhauling the 2014 law</b>                             | The 2014 law unamended                                           | Bill adopted by the Council of Ministers and not enacted; it would define security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations, revise electronic evidence and connection-data retention, and require operator cooperation with justice. Revision was reported again on 2026-08-15 alongside signature of the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime and accession to the World AI Cooperation Organization, with Interpol findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity given as the reason | ADVANCED |
| <b>Dedicated social-media law</b>                                           | Did not exist                                                    | Announced; no draft held (2026-06)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED |
| <b>Electronic signature and interoperability decree</b>                     | The 2015 electronic-signature law without an implementing decree | Draft decree validated and not adopted; a national interoperability committee provided for (2025-09)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED |
| <b>Order to block pornographic sites at internet service provider level</b> | Did not exist                                                    | In force as a cabinet decision; no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route specified (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED |

## Malawi

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>AI Bill</b>                                          | Did not exist; no artificial-intelligence statute or bill appears in the base at 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                 | Announced as the statutory backing for the National AI Strategy, to establish a regulatory framework promoting innovation while safeguarding citizen privacy and ensuring operational accountability; the ICT minister put the target for reaching parliament at before December 2026, with the strategy to ground the law. No draft text is stated and the strategy's own text is not held                                                                                    | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Data Protection Act 2024</b>                         | In force since 2024-06-03, with the regulator designated data protection authority; the statute exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance from compliance for 24 months from commencement, so most of the economy was outside the Act's obligations | In force, with the general exemption elapsed in early June 2026 so that all controllers and processors are within scope; subsidiary instruments to operate registration and enforcement were still in draft at 2026-08-06                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED, GRACE PERIOD ELAPSED |
| <b>Financial Crimes (Amendment) Bill No. 19 of 2026</b> | Did not exist; the base carries no bill or amendment on cheques or bearer negotiable instruments at 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                              | Passed by Parliament removing all references to cheques and bearer negotiable instruments from the principal Act, as one of four bills passed together: amendments to the Financial Crimes, Payment Systems and Deposit Insurance Corporation Acts following the Bills of Exchange (Amendment) Bill that effects the cheque phase-out. Assent, gazette date and commencement are not published, and the safeguarding regulations the finance minister promised are not drafted | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Government Data Sharing Regulation</b>               | Did not exist; the national data-exchange platform operated without binding rules and ministries, departments and agencies shared citizen data by email, USB drive and paper                                                                                                | A proposed regulation would route all data requests through the national data centre, require encryption in transit and at rest, set a common digital standard for system-to-system exchange, and require binding data sharing agreements with usage limits and audit trails; it is not made, and no draft text is held                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                       |
| <b>Review of the National Registration Act</b>          | The base carries no statement on the Act's status or on any review of it                                                                                                                                                                                                    | An acceleration-project consultative meeting has reviewed the National Registration Act and the marriage and family relations statute, with the registration bureau stating the aim is to support a modern and secure civil registration and identification system; no bill, draft or timetable is on record                                                                                                                                                                   | BASELINE NOT HELD              |

## Mali

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01  | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                     | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data-management law</b>                      | None published | Recommended; nothing tabled                                                                       | ADVANCED |
| <b>Platform-content enforcement instruction</b> | Did not exist  | In force as an instruction, built on existing penal and cybercrime provisions with no new statute | ADVANCED |
| <b>Startups law</b>                             | None published | Recommended; nothing tabled                                                                       | ADVANCED |



## Mauritania

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                      | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Startup Act</b>                              | Draft bill in public consultation, targeting 300 labelled start-ups and 3,000 jobs over five years | Enacted 2 January 2024; the promulgated text is not held, but the ministry's pre-enactment deck sets out a merit-based label with a preferential public-procurement margin (Article 13), a state-backed start-up fund and guarantee fund with investor tax incentives (Article 21), payroll-cost relief and a technology-innovation hub, and IP and customs relief | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Universal Service Access Fund governance</b> | Governed by Decree 2020-152 of 19 November 2020                                                    | A replacement decree approved on grounds that the fund's object, its resource mobilisation and allocation, and its integration into the state budgetary system were all unclear; the new terms are not published                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED          |
| <b>ANETA state digital agency proposal</b>      | BASELINE NOT HELD                                                                                  | Proposed by UNDP (31 July 2021) as an EPA under the digital ministry with about 50 staff, EUR 220,000 to set up and EUR 1.4m a year to run, and a draft creation decree; a June 2023 open-data strategy proposes reviving that decree to name the same body national interoperability operator; no adoption, decree or launch is on record                         | Baseline not held |

## Mauritius

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                   | AT 2025-08-01                        | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data Protection Officer Regulations 2026</b>                        | Did not exist                        | Promulgated, formalising designation, qualifications, independence and reporting duties for data protection officers across public and private sectors, with a six-month compliance window (2026-06)                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED |
| <b>Economic and Financial Measures (Miscellaneous Provisions) Bill</b> | Did not exist                        | 119 pages amending 58 Acts and repealing one, with staged commencement from 1 September 2026 and several provisions deemed retrospective, carrying the fintech committee, the AI City Scheme, the central bank threat-sharing platform, the virtual-asset solicitation rule and the digital travel authorisation; introduced, not enacted (2026-07)          | ADVANCED |
| <b>Electronic Transactions Act amendments</b>                          | Did not exist as a stated commitment | Referred to as modernising the digital-commerce framework and consumer protection; no text, timetable or introduction date published (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED |
| <b>Ministerial notice on online-content sanctions</b>                  | Did not exist                        | A ministry communiqué restating the criminal exposure of online speech and of page administrators who fail to moderate on notice                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED |
| <b>Social-media identity verification mechanism</b>                    | Did not exist                        | Consultations opened toward a verification mechanism against disinformation, impersonation, defamatory content, scams and child sexual abuse material, citing 2,300 online-harm cases from January to June 2026 and frauds up to Rs 500,000; no draft instrument published (2026-06)                                                                         | ADVANCED |
| <b>Virtual-asset solicitation rule</b>                                 | Did not exist                        | Unlicensed solicitation of investors in Mauritius would be prohibited by any medium, defined to reach targeted or algorithmic advertising, platforms, applications, social media, influencers, affiliates, referral codes, seminars and webinars, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target Mauritius; introduced, not enacted (2026-07) | ADVANCED |

## Morocco

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                  | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Digital health bill 52.26                                            | Did not exist                                                  | A 50-article bill adopted and now publicly opposed by doctors; implementing decrees due within 12 months of publication and provider connection within 24 months of the technical decree; text not published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED, CONTESTED               |
| Digital X.0 framework bill                                           | Did not exist                                                  | With the general secretariat; three pillars — data governance, sectoral digital identity, and interoperability on traceable consent; no text, article count or tabling date on record                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ADVANCED, NOTHING ON RECORD SINCE |
| Electoral organic bill 53.25                                         | Did not exist                                                  | A new article carries two to five years' imprisonment and a fine of MAD 50,000-100,000, with artificial-intelligence tools enumerated as a means of commission on four offences; candidacy filing and proxy voting via a dedicated electronic platform upheld under articles 154/72; new article 51 bis (fabrication, not mere dissemination) punishes AI-enabled election disinformation with 2-5 years and MAD 50,000-100,000, upheld against a press-freedom challenge | ADVANCED                          |
| Organic laws 54.25 on political parties and 55.25 on electoral lists | Not held                                                       | 54.25 constitutionally cleared alongside 53.25, promulgation dahir not yet held; 55.25 institutionalises internet-based electoral-roll registration (resident and expatriate) and bars AI tools and social platforms from publishing referendum poll results, committee-adopted across four sessions 12-27 November 2025                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED                          |
| Personal data protection law 09-08                                   | In force, commission supervising (2025-08)                     | In force since 2009; a recast bill is now in the legislative circuit per the regulator's own account (no transmission date or text held), described by the regulator as clarification rather than replacement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED                          |
| Private member's bill on regulating artificial intelligence          | A 17-article private member's bill before the bureau (2025-08) | Same; described as still under parliamentary deliberation, with no committee report or adoption on record                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE                         |

## Mozambique

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Cyber Security Law (Law 13/2026)            | Not on record at 2025-08-01; draft cyber bills approved by government 2025-09 | Approved by the Assembly of the Republic 2026-04-29, promulgated 2026-06-10 and published 2026-07-01, in force 90 days after publication on 2026-09-29 with implementing regulations due within 180 days; creates a national incident response team seated in INTIC and, at articles 67 to 71, a Cyber Security Fund managed by the National Cyber Security Authority and financed by a flat 1% of licensed cybersecurity providers' prior-year gross revenue under article 70(c), with licensed information and communications technology providers also obliged to contribute at no stated rate under article 67(3); secondary accounts put the penalty ceiling at 160 minimum wages and implementation cost at about 167.26m meticalais | ADVANCED |
| Cyber Security Law implementing regulations | Did not exist                                                                 | Provided for by Laws 13/2026 and 14/2026 and due within 180 days of their publication on 2026-07-01; none made at 2026-08-09                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Cybercrime Law (Law 14/2026)</b>                                    | Not on record at 2025-08-01; a draft cybercrime bill approved by government 2025-09                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Published alongside Law 13/2026 in Boletim da Republica I Serie n.o 123 of 2026-07-01, in force 2026-09-29 with implementing regulations due within 180 days; strengthens prevention, investigation and punishment of offences committed in cyberspace, provides for preservation and collection of digital evidence and for international cooperation, and repeals articles 256, 289, 336, 337, 338 and 339 of the Penal Code, replacing them with its own offences | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Data centre and cloud computing regulations</b>                     | Two drafts in public consultation to 2025-03-30, both dated 23 December 2024: registration required of any data-centre operator whether or not the facility is in Mozambique, a resident legal representative for providers established abroad, four data-centre resilience categories, cloud providers categorised by the classification of information they may process, financial-sector data confined to the two highest categories, classified information confined to private clouds on national territory, a single operator portal with tacit approval where the regulator does not decide in time, and a sanctioning regime with mandatory cybersecurity insurance (2025-03) | Published and in force; INTIC preparing to extend the licensing framework to data centres and cloud platforms                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Digital-operator licences issued</b>                                | None issued (2025-04)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 19 issued, about 170 companies under evaluation (2026-06)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Electronic Transactions Law licensing regime</b>                    | Licensing regulation for intermediary electronic service providers and digital platform operators in force, no licences issued (2025-04)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 19 licences issued of about 170 registered companies under evaluation; the fee is one national minimum wage plus 1% of revenue annually from the next fiscal year                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Telecommunications Traffic Control Regulations (Decree 48/2025)</b> | Approved by the Council of Ministers 2025-10-28 and published 2025-12-16; in force from 16 December 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | The powers to suspend or block services, compel call and internet-protocol detail records, issue binding technical norms and intervene in operator networks without consent are void; the government stated on 2026-08-04 that it will seek the same end by another route, naming no bill, instrument or timetable                                                                                                                                                   | REGRESSED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                      | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Universal Access Service Fund Regulation (Decree 11/2025)</b> | In force since 2025-05-16, replacing the regime under Decree 62/2017 of 9 November | In force: contributions payable in a single instalment by the last working day of June against audited accounts filed by 31 May; spending capped at 55% infrastructure expansion, 14% digital inclusion for vulnerable groups, 14% television broadcasting, 14% operating costs and 3% innovation; universal-access operators must charge 20% below the normal tariff; infrastructure built with fund money is state property with mandatory national roaming and contracts of ten years maximum; fines run to 114 minimum salaries, split 60% to the fund and 40% to the state budget. The regulator's 2024 annual report states the contribution as 1% of each licensed entity's gross revenue for the preceding financial year | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Online Copyright Protection Act</b>                           | Not held                                                                           | In drafting by the ICT institute for introduction next year, its board chairman naming authorship of artificial-intelligence output and liability for artificial-intelligence training as open questions the country has no law on                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Namibia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT           |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Corporate Laws Bill 2025</b>                     | Did not exist                                                                                                                                           | At Draft 3 and out for public comment: it consolidates and re-enacts the Companies Act with the business and intellectual property authority as registrar, and clause 114 would require every company, and every external company establishing a place of business in Namibia, to keep in Namibia a register of beneficial owners recording each owner's name, date of birth, identity-document number and residential, business, email and postal addresses; company process is routed through the Electronic Transactions Act | ADVANCED           |
| <b>Cybercrime Bill</b>                              | No bill named on the record; enforcement relying on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code                  | Named by the minister as being finalised alongside the data protection bill; no draft published and no tabling date given                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED, MARGINAL |
| <b>Data Protection Bill</b>                         | A tabling announced for September 2025, about twelve years after drafting began                                                                         | Not tabled and not enacted; no data-protection statute in force at 2026-08-06                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | STALLED            |
| <b>Data Protection Bill, latest published draft</b> | The March 2022 revised draft, 59 pages and eight Parts, the last version published for comment                                                          | The March 2022 revised draft remains the last version published for comment, with the supervisory authority at its Part 2; the draft's stated objects are establishing a Data Protection Supervisory Authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on data controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct; the 2020 version is held alongside it, and no later text and no tabling record has been published                                                                                | NO CHANGE          |
| <b>Electronic Transactions Act 2019</b>             | In force; covers electronic signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection | Unchanged; still the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE          |

## Niger

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                        | AT 2025-08-01                    | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Civil-status regime</b>                                                  | The previous civil-status regime | Ordonnance n2026-21 of 2026-04-22 with its application decret in force                                                 | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Enforcement against unauthorised satellite resale</b>                    | No enforcement action on file    | Formal notice against Wifi Zones with a 3 October 2025 deadline, carrying three months to a year and fines to 60m FCFA | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Loi 2018-45 prior-authorisation regime for electronic communications</b> | In force                         | In force and enforced                                                                                                  | NO CHANGE |

## Nigeria

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01   | AT 2026-08-21                                            | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Cybercrimes (Amendment) Act 2024</b> | In force (2024) | In force; lawyers argue it is misapplied against dissent | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                               | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>7.5% VAT on electronic banking fees</b>                         | Did not exist      | 7.5% VAT on electronic banking fees                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>CBN payments data-localisation directive</b>                    | Did not exist      | Binding from 2027-01-01; no power sequencing published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>DEON digital consumer-lending regulations</b>                   | In force (2025-07) | In force and enforced, with the WASPAN appeal before the Court of Appeal and the existing framework held in place by ministerial direction                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED, NOW UNDER APPEAL |
| <b>Market-concentration caps and operational ring-fencing</b>      | Did not exist      | 25% of issuing against 15% of acquiring, on monthly market-share returns                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill</b>              | Did not exist      | Would elevate NITDA to a super regulator; overlap flagged by stakeholders                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>NIMC Act 2026</b>                                               | Did not exist      | Replaces the 2007 Act; the NIN made the foundational credential                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>Presidential Executive Order on Virtual Assets Coordination</b> | Did not exist      | A Virtual Asset Council and Office with its secretariat at the central bank                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>Tax collected by the revenue service</b>                        | Baseline not held  | NGN 27.1 trillion (US\$19.93bn) between January and July 2026, an average NGN 127.83bn (US\$93.98m) a day - 95.76% of the whole of 2025's collection and two-thirds of the NGN 40.71 trillion 2026 target - which the revenue service credits to digitised tax systems, four 2025 reform laws and an executive order closing loopholes | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>Virtual-asset tax framework</b>                                 | Did not exist      | 1.5% stamp duty withheld in the asset itself and remitted in the originating token, alongside value-added tax and withholding tax; peer-to-peer and over-the-counter traders warned on 2026-08-14 that the charge could push activity into unregulated channels, the rules having been signed 2026-07-31 and announced 2026-08-03      | ADVANCED                   |
| <b>Investments and Securities Act 2025 treatment of crypto</b>     | In force (2025-05) | Crypto inside the securities perimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | NO CHANGE                  |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Judicial communique on digital evidence and artificial intelligence</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Fifty-four judicial officers called for stricter authentication standards for AI-generated evidence and a review of the digital-evidence, cybercrime and privacy statutes, named genuine evidence dismissed as AI-fabricated as an emerging problem, questioned whether clicking agreement constitutes meaningful consent, and asked for electronic case management, virtual hearings and privacy-protected judicial platforms | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>FCCPC competition probe of platforms and AI firms</b>    | Did not exist                 | Competition law used against uncompensated AI training on Nigerian journalism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Framework for Compensation of Consumers</b>              | Did not exist                 | Automatic airtime credit in listed local government areas, with the qualifying thresholds unpublished                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Internet-platform regulation</b>                         | Rules in force                | Enforcement paused pending a unified digital-economy policy framework                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>REGRESSED</b>         |
| <b>NDPA amendment bill</b>                                  | Did not exist                 | Before the assembly                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Private enforcement of data-protection rights</b>        | Did not exist                 | ₦15m general damages for marketing after consent was withdrawn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Securities regulator virtual-asset rules</b>             | Did not exist                 | Proposed: registration for offshore firms serving Nigerians, API-level access to transaction and wallet data, and capital floors up to ₦2bn                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Social-media local-presence bill</b>                     | Before the assembly (2025-03) | Through a Senate committee public hearing and into public consultation, with organised support and organised opposition on the record                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>FCCPC consumer-protection penalty against Meta</b>       | Imposed, under appeal (2025)  | Under appeal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| <b>Nigeria Tax Act 2025 and Tax Administration Act 2025</b> | In force (2025)               | The statutory base for the virtual-asset tax circular                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| <b>NIMC Act 2026 substantive provisions</b>                 | Not held                      | On a law firm's reading of the Act: the identity commission becomes the root certification authority for a national public key infrastructure and the national biometric-data repository; use of the national identification number is made mandatory across passports, banking, telecommunications and land dealings, while the Act states that proof of identity is not proof of eligibility or of citizenship; and unauthorised database access carries penalties of at least NGN10m or five years for an individual and NGN20m for a body corporate | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-21                                                                  | MOVEMENT        |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Risk-based AI regime in the digital-economy bill</b> | Did not exist | High-risk systems would face annual impact assessments; the bill is not passed | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

## Rwanda

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT        |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Draft law on virtual assets</b>       | Did not exist                                      | The rationale approved in principle and referred to committee; not enacted, with no text and no gazette date                                                                                    | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| <b>Single digital identification law</b> | In force, with nationwide enrolment not yet opened | Enrolment open and scaling, with banks, hospitals, telecoms operators and government institutions expected to use the new authentication from the sunset date and legacy cards becoming invalid | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01                                         | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Central bank regulatory sandbox</b> | Operating, with no published cohort or admission data | Still operating and cited as a sequencing model, with no cohort list, admission count or graduation figure held | NO CHANGE |

## Sao Tome and Principe

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                                | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-17                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>National Framework for Interoperability (Law 1/2024)</b>                                         | <i>Baseline not held</i> | In force since 2024; underpins DEX, single citizen portal, trade single window                                                  | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Personal Data Guarantee and Protection Law (Law 03/2016)</b>                                     | <i>Baseline not held</i> | In force since 2016; fines up to STN 500m for legal entities, criminal sanctions up to 1 year imprisonment for serious breaches | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>AGER regulatory framework revision (Regulatory Entities Law + Electronic Communications Law)</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Bills submitted; passage not confirmed in sources held                                                                          | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| <b>Aggregated Identification Document Law (identity law)</b>                                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Under review/consultation; passage not confirmed                                                                                | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Senegal

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                              | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Critical-infrastructure protection legal framework</b>   | None held                                                  | Law n° 25/2026 on the protection of critical information infrastructure and digital security was adopted unanimously by the National Assembly on 2026-08-20, seven days after reaching its intercommission. On the ministry's account it grades obligations by risk - ordinary networks and systems on standard requirements, critical infrastructure on enhanced ones covering monitoring, data backup, encryption of sensitive information, business continuity and disaster recovery, and regular resilience testing - establishes a National Cybersecurity Authority, a national computer emergency response team, sectoral teams and cybersecurity operations services, mandates in-country storage of state-sensitive data, and folds in technology-neutral standards for the AI era and the child-online-protection plan PAPEL. No promulgation date, gazette reference or text is published | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Décret n. 2026-807 on classified defence procurement</b> | Did not exist                                              | In force; contracts and partnerships concerning critical information infrastructure are an enumerated ground for defence classification, gatekept by a presidency-chaired commission, with silence after fifteen days counting as refusal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Startup Act and labelling process</b>                    | The implementing decree adopted; labelling not yet running | The labelling process launched                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED                              |
| <b>Bill on a media and social-network regulator</b>         | A draft unveiled, entering the legislative process         | Unchanged in held material                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE, NO SOURCE SINCE 2025-01-24 |

## Seychelles

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                      | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                    | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| NISTI Act 2025 (National Institute of Science, Technology and Innovation) | Did not exist     | Assented 22 Dec 2025; commences on a date the Minister appoints — no commencement date on record | ADVANCED          |
| Access to Information Act 2018 (ATIA) reform                              | BASELINE NOT HELD | Whitepaper published, drafting targeted end-2025; no Bill text or introduction date on record    | Baseline not held |

## Sierra Leone

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Electronic Transactions Act 2019                   | In force since 5 December 2019 with no certification authorities, evidence procedures, dispute mechanisms or penalties established (2025-07) | A gap analysis, policy memorandum and implementation roadmap commissioned under the READY Salone project running to 2028; no adoption date for any of the three (2026-07)                                                                   | ADVANCED  |
| Subscribers Regulations 2025 (SIM-NIN enforcement) | Did not exist; the 2020 Subscribers Identification and Registration Management Regulations were the instrument on file (2025-07)             | Operators fined 25,000 new leones per unregistered or pre-activated SIM, with a staged disconnection ladder; the six-month transition clock is presented as running from the announcement, so the phase-out date is unestablished (2026-07) | ADVANCED  |
| National Communications Authority Act 2022         | In force, with enforcement powers addressed to licensees (2025-07)                                                                           | In force and unamended; the analysis finds its powers bind licensees only, leaving foreign platforms outside the perimeter, and identifies s.194 as the route to close the gaps without new primary legislation (2026-07)                   | NO CHANGE |

## Somalia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01                                                                               | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Cybersecurity Law    | Did not exist; a cybercrime bill of August 2025 was the only instrument on record (2025-08) | In force, assigning policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators, and creating the incident response team (2026-01) | ADVANCED |

## South Africa

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21                        | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------|----------|
| Electronic Communications Amendment Bill | Baseline not held | Published; submissions to 2026-08-21 | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21           | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|-------------------|
| National Identification and Registration Bill | BASELINE NOT HELD | Still before Parliament | Baseline not held |



| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                         | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Capital Flow Management Regulations and Crypto Asset Manual   | Did not exist                         | Both in draft; manual comments to end-September 2026; the Treasury and the central bank published a draft crypto asset manual for cross-border activities for comment to 30 September 2026, setting authorisation and reporting rules for crypto asset service providers and defining cross-border crypto flows | ADVANCED            |
| Copyright Amendment Bill                                      | Baseline not held                     | Constitutional Court ruling 2026-06                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED            |
| End-user and Subscriber Service Charter Amendment Regulations | In consultation                       | Gazetted 2026-01-23; under review application                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED, LITIGATED |
| Operation Vulindlela reporting                                | 80% of initiatives on track (2026-04) | "Uneven and slower than anticipated"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | REGRESSED           |
| POPIA enforcement notices                                     | None held                             | Three notices, May–June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED            |
| SADC real-time settlement                                     | Rand only since 2013                  | Kwanza added 2026-07-27                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED            |
| Breach notification rate                                      | ~284 per month (Apr–Nov 2025)         | ~263 per month (Q1 2026)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | NO CHANGE           |
| National Open Science Policy                                  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>              | Implemented (undated)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Baseline not held   |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21               | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------|
| Conduct of Financial Institutions Bill | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In development (2026-01-30) | Baseline not held |

## South Sudan

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01                                                              | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT                       |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act 2026 | Did not exist                                                              | In force; the full text was withheld from journalists at signing (2026-02)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                       |
| ICT Authority                            | Did not exist                                                              | Being established as a state entity under the ICT ministry while legislation is awaited (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED                       |
| South Sudan Official Gazette             | Not operating; no law, decree or resolution published since 2011 (2025-08) | A technical committee ordered to operationalise the physical and electronic editions with encrypted digital verification, read-only public access on a redesigned presidential website, and clearance of the publication backlog since 2011; no maiden edition is on file (2026-08)                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED, NO EDITION PUBLISHED |
| National Payment System Bill, 2025       | Not held                                                                   | Validated at a five-day workshop opened on 10 August 2026 by the central bank and parliament, backed by the East African Community secretariat and the Bank of Uganda, covering mobile money, electronic money, payment switches and real-time gross settlement with licensing, consumer-protection and systemic-risk provisions; on 17 August the central bank governor called for faster progress toward passage | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>       |

## Sudan

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Border-trade legal framework (state-level protocols) | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Resolution passed to review and unify state-level agreements; no transition arrangement, timetable or affected-protocol list given | Baseline not held |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Draft Digital Transformation Law of 2026</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | No text published. The justice ministry states it is preparing the instrument in coordination with the digital transformation and communications ministry, as the Digital Transformation Regulation Law of 2026 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Tanzania

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                            | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Financial consumer protection amendment regulations</b>      | In force from 2025-05-23 | Unchanged; providers must protect consumer financial and personal information in accordance with the data-protection Act                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>NO CHANGE</b>         |
| <b>Review of more than 1,000 laws for technology investment</b> | Not held                 | The government says it will review more than 1,000 laws, including the public-private partnership act, the companies act and financial legislation, to build a regulatory framework supporting artificial intelligence, digital commerce and technology investment under the 2050 development vision | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Togo

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                  | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Anti-money-laundering law of 2025</b>                                    | The 2018 statute in force, with no risk-based approach and no due diligence on virtual-asset service providers | The 2025 law adopted, replacing the 2018 statute with a risk-based approach, due diligence extended to virtual-asset service providers and strengthened beneficial-ownership identification                                                                    | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Decret n 2023-040/PR on electronic-communications fees and royalties</b> | In force as signed, with no satellite or satellite machine-to-machine spectrum royalty rates                   | Amended on 2026-07-30 to price spectrum use for satellite services and machine-to-machine traffic; the amending text was unpublished at 2026-07-31                                                                                                             | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Rules on mobile commercial offers</b>                                    | Did not exist                                                                                                  | New provisions governing the validity and billing conditions of mobile commercial offers and their promotional mechanisms                                                                                                                                      | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| <b>Commercial-courts reform and Hague Apostille accession bills</b>         | Not held                                                                                                       | Two bills adopted in first reading by the National Assembly, one reforming the commercial-courts law to complete electronic filing and online hearings and align with the OHADA uniform act, the other authorising accession to the Hague Apostille Convention | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Tunisia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                         | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT        |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Compulsory e-invoicing (Article 53)</b>        | Legislated to take effect 1 January 2026 for all service providers regardless of invoice value or firm size (2025-08) | Under amendment: parliament's memo records that no unified national e-invoicing system yet exists and that mass e-invoicing raises serious personal- and professional-data protection issues, and the amendment mandates a 30-day joint ministerial report on readiness and data-protection compliance before a phased timeline (2026-02) | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| <b>Development Plan 2026-2030 (loi n 2026-16)</b> | Did not exist as an adopted instrument                                                                                | Promulgated as the binding reference for public policy to 2030 under articles 75 and 77 of the Constitution, adopted by the Assembly on 10 July and the Council of Regions on 17 July (2026-07)                                                                                                                                           | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                   | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Organic Laws 22 and 23 of 2024 on biometric identity</b> | In force; use was targeted for the first half of 2025 and unconfirmed (2025-08) | In force; nothing held confirms issuance has begun, and an amendment to prohibit a centralised biometric database held by the interior ministry was introduced the day before the vote and dismissed (2026-08) | NO CHANGE |

## Uganda

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01                                                               | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Computer Misuse Act ss.11, 23, 26-29</b>            | In force and the state's main tools for prosecuting online speech (2025-08) | Struck down, together with Penal Code ss.162-163 on criminal libel                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | REGRESSED |
| <b>Protection of Sovereignty Bill, 2026</b>            | Not on file (2025-08)                                                       | Before joint parliamentary committees in April 2026; described as recently enacted on 2026-08-02, with no assent date, gazette notice or text held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Telecom-infrastructure vandalism enforcement</b>    | No convictions on file (2025-08)                                            | A five-year sentence for mast vandalism in Kibaale, US\$23.6m of damage, and a one-year sentence for a SIM-registration breach                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED  |
| <b>UCC enforcement against unlicensed public Wi-Fi</b> | Did not exist (2025-08)                                                     | Nationwide campaign under way; unlicensed operators told to regularise or cease; no count of operators actioned                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED  |
| <b>UCC order suspending public internet</b>            | No shutdown order in force (2025-08)                                        | Connectivity cut from 18:00 local (15:00 UTC) 2026-01-13 and restored 23:00 local (20:00 UTC) 2026-01-17 — 4 days 5 hours by measurement; UCC announced restoration from midnight 2026-01-18 with social media and OTT apps still blocked; full restoration announced 2026-01-26, 13 days after the order. The Uganda Law Society called it unlawful for want of a state of emergency; the directives were ordered tabled on 2026-03-10 | ADVANCED  |

## Zambia

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                                    | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025, statutory text</b> | The statutory text was not held, so the Act's provisions rested on secondary characterisation                                                                    | Held in full. Assented 8 April 2025, published in the Supplement to the Government Gazette 15 April 2025, commenced 12 May 2025 by Statutory Instrument 22 of 2025; 66 sections in seven Parts, repealing and replacing the Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021. Part V (sections 21 to 40) is the interception regime and is gated on a judge of the High Court                                             | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026</b>            | Did not exist. Cabinet approved the review of the Postal Services Act No. 22 of 2009 in principle at its 17th meeting in September 2025, after the window opened | Ten-province stakeholder consultations concluded 2026-07-22 and a public call for written submissions closed 2026-07-27; the Bill would repeal and replace the 2009 Act, strengthen universal service obligations, modernise licensing, reinforce regulatory oversight and extend services to underserved areas through the universal access fund. No draft text, gazette notice or parliamentary date is on file | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Mobile money levy</b>                                | In force under a 2023 levy act                                                                                                                                   | In force, with the rate doubled at some point in 2025; the industry levy table is stated as current to Q3 2025. No Zambian rate, base, statutory instrument, effective date or revenue outturn is held                                                                                                                                                                                                            | NO CHANGE |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                                                             | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>ICT (Universal Access) Regulations, 2012</b> | No position held on the statutory basis of Zambia's universal-access levy | Statutory Instrument No. 38 of 2012 sets the licensee contribution to the Universal Access and Service Fund at not exceeding 1.5% of gross annual turnover, capped at 50% of total collectable annual operating fees payable to the regulator, payable annually in advance; the Fund may also receive parliamentary appropriations, grants and donations. No amendment, repeal or updated rate is on record. | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| <b>Startup Bill</b>                             | Baseline not held                                                         | Named once, alongside the National AI Strategy, as an instrument through which the government would advance artificial intelligence; no text, sponsor, drafting stage, timetable or budget is held                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Zimbabwe

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                   | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Local-ownership rule for telecommunications operators and its repeal</b> | Did not exist                                                                                   | A 75% citizen-ownership floor and a 25% foreign-ownership ceiling for every postal and telecommunications licence, with sworn beneficial-ownership affidavits, 90 days for existing licensees to file a regularisation plan and three years to comply; reported repealed in full by Statutory Instrument 111 of 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>CLOSED, GAZETTED THEN REPEALED</b> |
| <b>Postal and Telecommunications (Amendment) Bill, 2025</b>                 | Did not exist                                                                                   | Gazetted 2025-10-10 and not in force, commencement left to a date the President fixes by statutory instrument; before the Parliamentary Legal Committee at 2026-08-02 with the National Assembly adjourned to 2026-08-18; the replacement section 25 fences the minister's power to direct the regulator, requiring directions to be prospective, of general application and consistent with the Act                                                                                                                                     | <b>ADVANCED</b>                       |
| <b>Regulatory Notice 1 of 2026</b>                                          | Did not exist                                                                                   | A warning to unlicensed data controllers, with surveillance and biometric processors expressly in scope                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>ADVANCED</b>                       |
| <b>Regulatory Notice 2 of 2026</b>                                          | Did not exist                                                                                   | Issued; risk-based inspections from 2026-09-01, with the sector list and fee tiers known only through press                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>ADVANCED</b>                       |
| <b>Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 on data-controller licensing</b>        | The licensing deadline lapsed with wide non-compliance; no enforcement step on record (2025-08) | Mandatory compliance inspections set for 2026-09-01; four fee tiers by data-subject count — US\$50 a year for 50-1,000 subjects, US\$300 plus a US\$30 application fee for 1,001-100,000, and US\$500-2,500 above that; a separate certified Data Protection Officer requirement costs US\$1,250 plus a US\$30 application fee, so a small organisation faces over US\$1,300 in first-year compliance cost; processing without a licence carries a Level 11 fine and up to seven years' imprisonment for the accountable chief executive | <b>ADVANCED</b>                       |
| <b>Third constitutional amendment on the voters' roll</b>                   | The roll held by the electoral commission under the 2013 Constitution                           | Transfer to the registrar-general under way; no date, transition plan or safeguard stated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>ADVANCED</b>                       |
| <b>Cyber and Data Protection Act</b>                                        | In force; the regulator designated as data protection authority                                 | Unamended; administrative sanctions still not provided for (2026-05-14)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <b>NO CHANGE</b>                      |

## Southern Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Digital platform governance toolkit (RIA/UNESCO)               | Did not exist                                      | Published with a five-part self-assessment checklist, eight legislative building blocks and a five-tier escalation ladder; no regulator adoption on record | ADVANCED  |
| SADC Computer Crime and Cybercrime Model Law                   | In force as a model since November 2012, unrevised | Unchanged; no revision, successor or transposition record held                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |
| SADC Electronic Transactions and Electronic Commerce Model Law | In force as a model since November 2012, unrevised | Unchanged; no revision, successor or transposition record held                                                                                             | NO CHANGE |

## West Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM              | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-21                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Cybercrime statutes in the Sahel states | BASELINE NOT HELD | A press-freedom organisation reports the cybercrime statutes of Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger and Guinea being used to prosecute journalists, and calls for the repeal of vague public-order and human-dignity provisions | Baseline not held |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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